Topic 4: RAG vs Normal LLM

Simple RAG Project - Requirements Guide

Compare an LLM answering from learned knowledge with a RAG system that retrieves current or private context.

What this topic requires

The comparison must cover hallucinations, knowledge limits, private data, changing information, domain specificity, advantages, and disadvantages.

Required understanding and workflow

1. Describe the normal LLM path.

2. Describe the RAG path.

3. Compare grounding, freshness, complexity, and cost.

4. Explain that retrieval improves evidence access but does not guarantee truth.

5. Document trade-offs.

Workflow

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Normal: user -> LLM -> answer | RAG: user -> retriever -> context -> LLM -> answer
```

Evidence rule

Describe implementation only after repository inspection. Missing features must be labeled NOT IMPLEMENTED IN THIS PROJECT. Recommendations must be labeled PRODUCTION RECOMMENDATION - NOT CURRENTLY IMPLEMENTED.